

# GTM Engineering: What It Is, How It Works, and How to Hire

Your GTM motion isn't under-staffed—it's under-engineered.

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Your GTM motion isn't under-staffed. It's under-engineered.

If you're a GTM leader whose team is bogged down by manual research, slow campaigns, or data cleaning, more effort won't fix things. You need better systems. And GTM engineers are the ones who build them.

GTM engineers build revenue engines using AI and automation. Since we coined this role in 2023, it has emerged at companies like [Cursor](#), [Lovable](#), and [Webflow](#). Today, about 100 GTME job listings go live every month.

GTM engineers (GTMEs) can solve problems across any revenue-critical function. That includes:

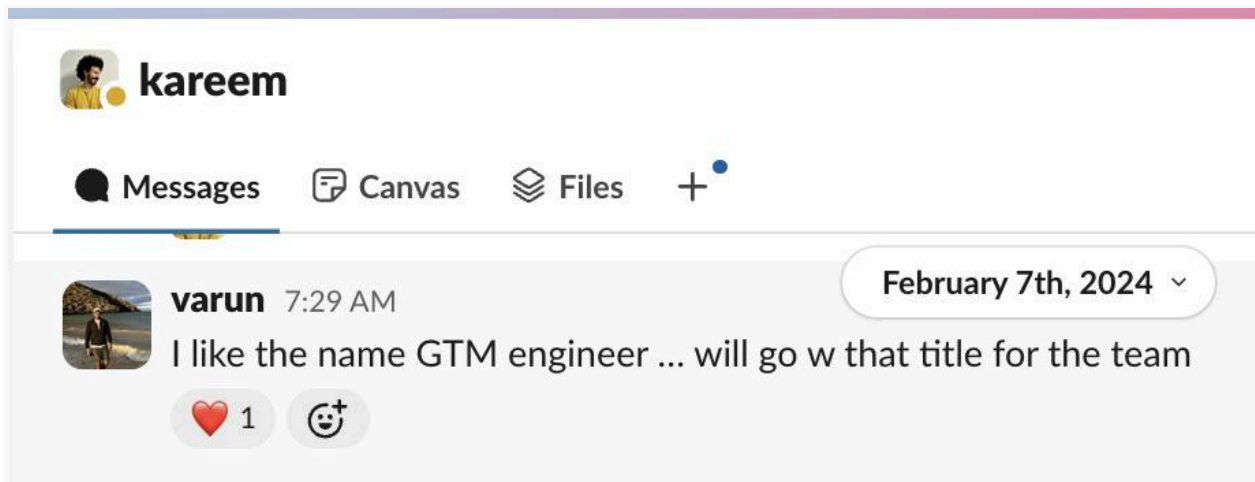
- RevOps: Automate manual seller work (e.g. replace manual account research, update CRMs based on call transcripts, send follow-up emails, etc.)
- Growth: Automate demand gen and ABM (e.g. Monitor complaints against competitors on social platforms and launch personalized campaigns within hours).
- Customer success: Automate retention and expansion plays (e.g. analyze support tickets to predict churn and send targeted retentive emails).

Ops teams have always been the backbone of revenue teams. Now, with AI, they're stepping into their most strategic era yet. Their job is changing from *data plumber* to *growth architect*: someone who tests hypotheses and scales what works, without waiting for developers or manual research. When ops teams turn into GTM engineers, they stop reacting to tickets and start proactively growing revenue.

In this guide, we share how GTM engineering is evolving at Clay, describe live GTME workflows, and offer advice for how to structure and hire GTMEs in your organization based on our top customers' setups. (Follow our [GTME substack](#) to get future essays on this topic in your inbox).

TL;DR

- GTM engineering is the practice of building automated revenue systems using AI, data enrichment, and workflow automation. Clay coined the term in 2023 and about 100 GTME job listings go live every month.
- GTM engineers work across RevOps, growth, and customer success. Their work progresses through three rungs: data foundation, data modeling, and data activation.
- Most companies embed GTMEs inside RevOps first, then federate outward. Companies like Intercom, Canva, Notion, Verkada, and Ramp have all built distinct GTME structures.
- Great GTM engineers are hybrids: part commercial thinker, part builder. Look for technical fluency, commercial bias, curiosity, and an experimental mindset. Assess them with a business problem investigation, a systems sketch, and a mini build challenge.



## Why GTM engineering is the winning operating model now

Two shifts made traditional GTM roles and processes obsolete:

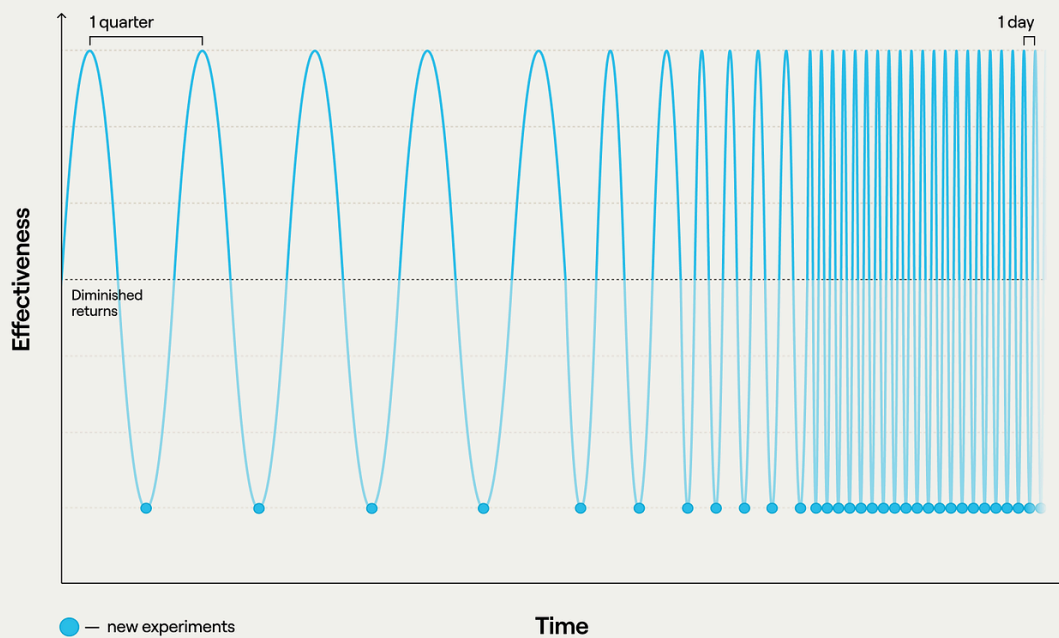
First, GTM tactics became commoditized. The sales tactics that worked in 2010 fall flat today. Prospects get hundreds of generic cold emails, and spam filters ignore "quick question" subject lines. Winning companies continuously find a competitive edge, or [GTM alpha](#), with unique data and differentiated plays.

Second, AI eliminated the need for custom manual research and engineering. AI can research thousands of companies at once. APIs can pull data from anywhere. What required either manual research or engineering talent two years ago is now easy no-code automation. This unlocked the ability to test highly targeted, creative approaches at scale.

These shifts created both the need and the opportunity for GTM engineering. The commoditization of tactics demanded creativity. AI made that creativity executable, collapsing the gap between idea and execution from months to hours.

GTM engineers find and fix revenue bottlenecks. They can discover that you should spend resources targeting NYC cafes with \$10-20 entrees who just joined DoorDash, and help you reach them tomorrow, not next quarter.

## GTMEs shrink iteration cycles



GTM engineering at Clay

At Clay, our GTM engineers act like an internal product team that serves our GTM organization. They identify problems, write specs, ship prototypes, and scale what works, measuring success by metrics like meetings booked and hours saved.

Their work impacts sales enablement, growth marketing, customer success, and more. They both invent new workflows and scale promising tactics from individual experiments. For example, a seller recently built a custom Clay table to track buying signals and draft outreach for top prospects. The GTME team templated the build and rolled it out org-wide within days.

**GTM Ops Intake** WORKFLOW 4:22 PM

New request from @kash

**How can we help?**

Hey team, I'd like to develop the Clay table I built for my onboarding project into a lifecycle campaign (after making improvements and changes) and I'm looking for some guidance on how to replicate a similar workflow with our own customer data.

- I had used a one-time report sync from SFDC for the purpose of the onboarding project. In this case, I'd need to run this real-time for all free trial signups
- Here's a [notion page](#) with more details on the project, and objectives. It also links to the Clay table and highlights a few examples.

I can own refining the Claygent prompt, improving the table (can create a new one if needed), and setting up the Inflection tokens, but would love some help getting this set up in our internal Clay environment + sending the right event(s) from Segment to Inflection. Thanks!

**Related link(s)**

<https://www.notion.so/clayrun/Personalized-Onboarding-with-Claygent-2067e66eb01480d692f2ff6ebf7d4d0e>

**Related workflow(s):**

Other @osman

 **3 replies** Last reply today at 4:24 PM

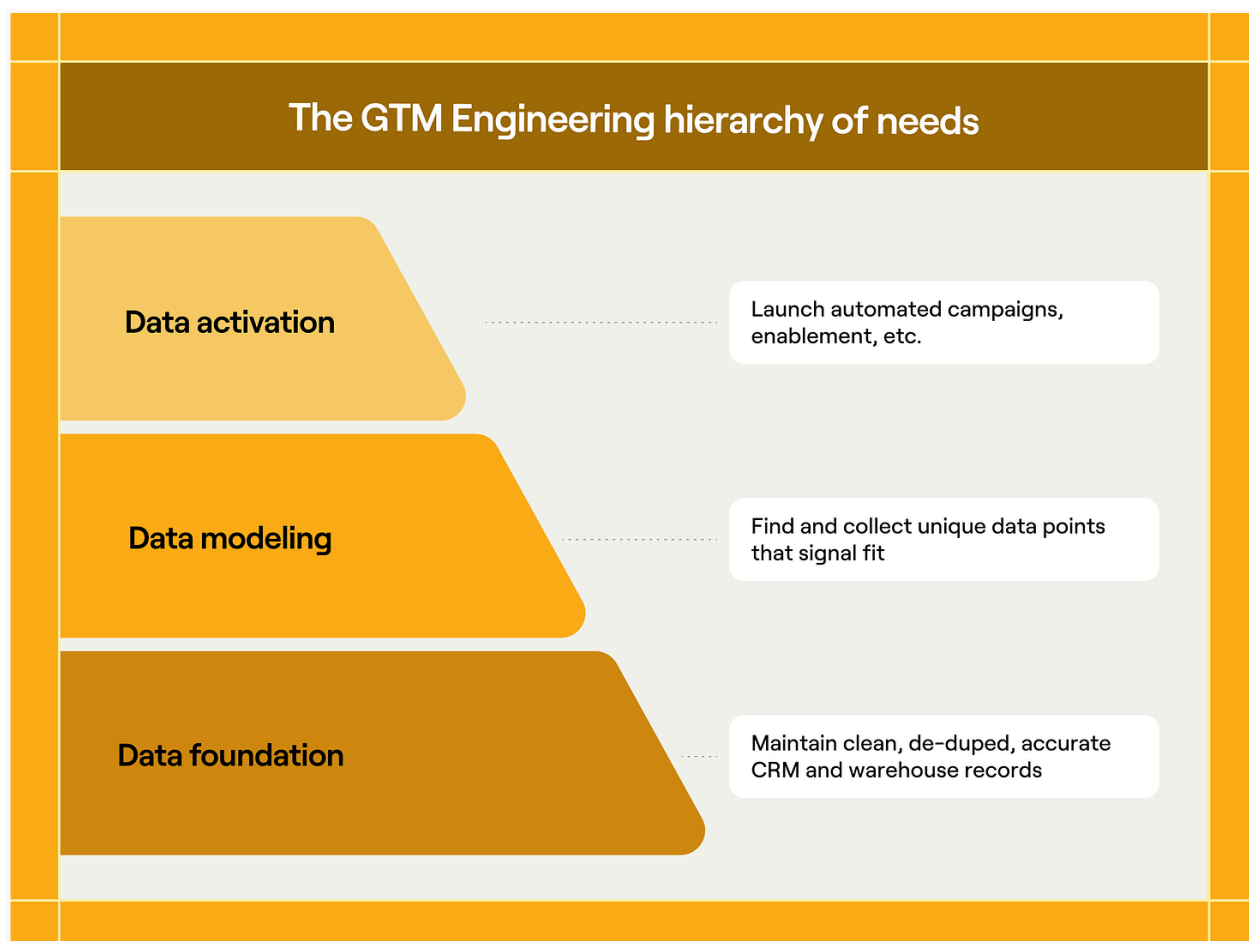
More unique to Clay: our GTMEs also act as consultative sellers. Just as [Harvey](#) uses lawyers to sell legal software and [Prompt Health](#) uses therapists to sell and support their product, Clay uses GTMEs to sell Clay. These sellers have deep empathy for our customers and speak their language.

# How GTM engineering solves problems across RevOps, growth, and customer success

Our GTMEs tackle RevOps, Growth, and CX challenges by first nailing the basics: a clean, trustworthy CRM. Without that data foundation, nothing scales.

Like data scientists, GTM Engineers offer a portable toolkit that only works when the stack beneath it is solid. Their work progresses through three rungs, each building upon the last:

1. Data foundation: Keep CRM and warehouse records clean, deduped, and trustworthy. (Automated enrichment jobs, schema audits, "merge-and-purge" routines, and ownership rules.)
2. Data modeling: Collect unique data points that predict purchase, expansion, or churn. (Building propensity scores, defining ICP attributes, and adding AI-data points.)
3. Data activation: Deploy unique data points in revenue-generating workflows. (Automated outreach, meeting notes, churn-risk or expansion nudges, sales enablement, etc).



Most companies stumble on the first rung. They either try fancy campaigns on incomplete, dirty, or duplicate-riddled data, or waste 80% of their time on data hygiene (updating records, validating info, fixing duplicates) and leave only 20% for strategic work.

GTM Engineers flip this ratio: they automate the hygiene work so teams can spend their hours experimenting and fine-tuning ICP. Below are real builds from Clay to show what that means.

Revenue operations & seller enablement

RevOps often focuses on increasing sales efficiency. That could include scoring and replying to inbound interest, auto-updating your CRM based on call recordings, and more.

- Intelligent inbound routing: Manny and Osman's model scores new sign-ups for \$25k-plus potential, auto-assigns the best leads, and even drafts meeting notes and follow-up messages that mention similar customer use cases and custom signals.
- Signal digests in Slack: Osman pipes signal digests to individual sellers for account awareness and call prep.
- VIP event invites: Spencer cross-references event data with geolocation data to surface perfect event invitees, and automatically follows up on behalf of sellers.
- One-click call rescheduling: A reschedule link fires whenever a prospect misses a call to suggest a new time to meet.
- Transcript-powered data entry: Blake's script listens to calls, extracts firmographics, and backfills Salesforce, so reps don't waste time in the CRM.

## Growth marketing

Growth focuses on demand generation: finding the right prospects, personalizing outreach, and rapid-testing new channels.

- Activation plays: Osman and Manny automated a playbook that lifted trial conversion rates. They also run plays for activated workspaces and new promising customers. Each of these have centralized lead scoring and routing.
- Programmatic partner sourcing: Tommy scraped social media and website profiles, scored fit, and launched our influencer marketing program.

- Dynamic visitor campaigns: Pranav's workflow watches reverse-IP data and triggers personalized emails while interest is hottest.

## Customer success & expansion

CX focuses on retaining revenue by spotting risk early and acting on upsell moments.

- Ticket-spike alarms with docs: Bruno's workflow flags surges in support tickets and drafts the help center articles that prevent the next wave.
- CX idea generator: Spencer merged Salesforce and Claygent data to recommend bespoke plays for CSMs to suggest to their accounts.



Clay Bot APP 10:16 AM

Yesterday ▾

Potential Clay Use Cases - [redacted]

#### 1. Device Ownership Analysis

- Data Point: Number of [redacted] devices owned by skincare professionals/clinics
- Collection Method: Claygent research of online articles, press releases, industry publications
- Prompt: "Find the number of [redacted] devices owned by [Skincare Professional/Clinic Name]"
- Business Value: Assess operation scale and identify upselling opportunities for new models or additional devices

#### 2. Booster Usage Tracking

- Data Point: Most frequently used [redacted] boosters
- Collection Method: Claygent analysis of customer reviews, social media posts, forums
- Prompt: "What are the most frequently used [redacted] boosters by [Skincare Professional/Clinic Name]?"
- Business Value: Tailor product recommendations and identify cross-selling opportunities

#### 3. Training & Certification Monitoring

- Data Point: Participation in [redacted] training programs/certifications
- Collection Method: Claygent search of professional websites, social media, training databases
- Prompt: "Has [Skincare Professional/Clinic Name] participated in [redacted] training programs or certifications?"
- Business Value: Assess expertise and identify opportunities for advanced training

#### 4. Co-Branding Partnership Tracking

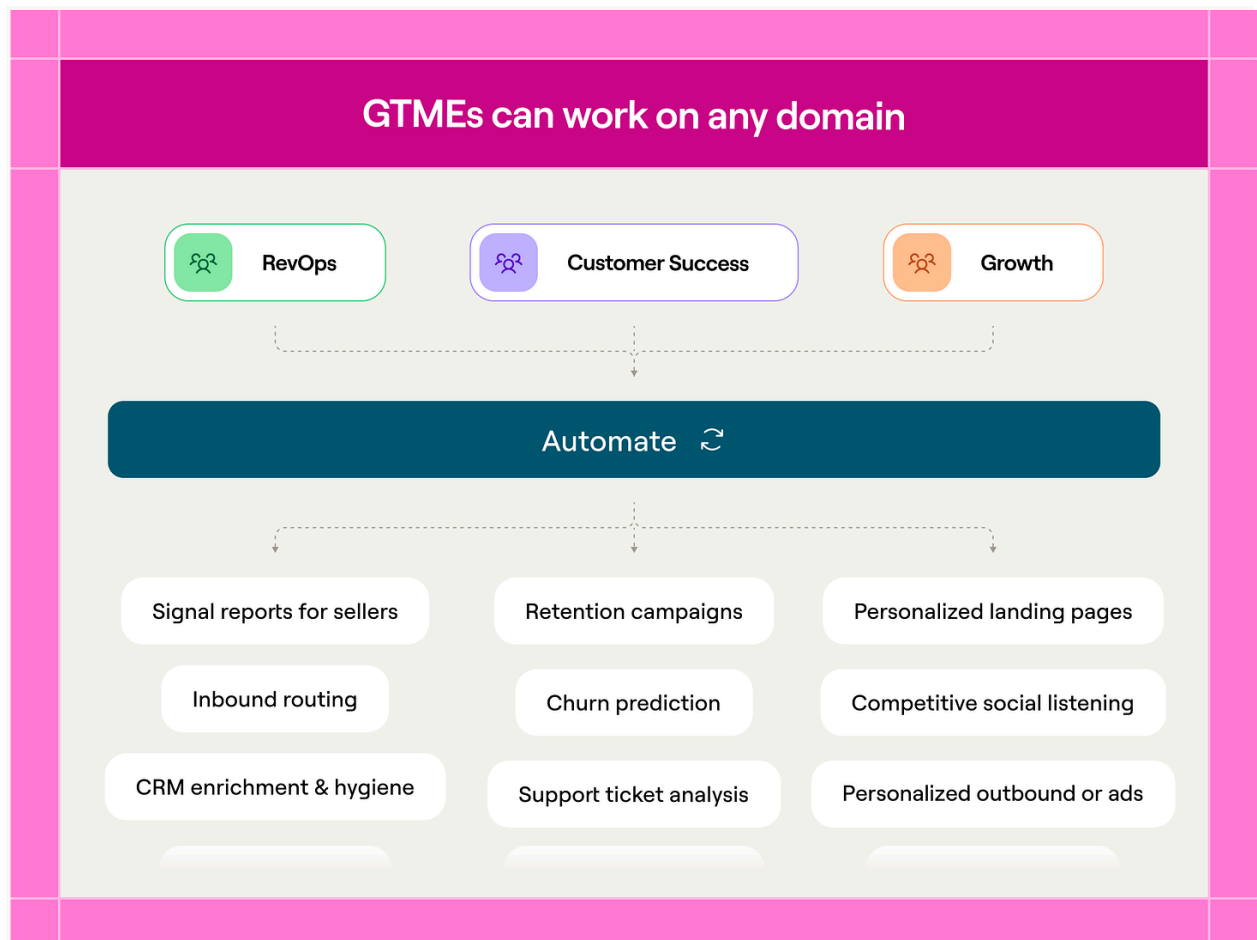
- Data Point: Co-branded marketing activities and partnerships
- Collection Method: Claygent analysis of professional websites, social media, marketing materials
- Prompt: "Has [Skincare Professional/Clinic Name] engaged in co-branded marketing activities with [redacted]?"
- Business Value: Identify brand advocates and potential marketing collaboration opportunities

#### 5. Social Media Engagement Analysis

- Data Point: Engagement rates on [redacted]-related posts
- Collection Method: Claygent analysis of social media metrics
- Prompt: "What is the social media engagement rate on [redacted]-related posts by [Skincare Professional/Clinic Name]?"
- Business Value: Assess customer influence and marketing effectiveness

- Smart support routing: When someone contacts support asking for a sales meeting, our system qualifies them instantly and sends a meeting link if they're a good fit. No manual handoff needed.

- Expansion radar: Osman scans support threads for enterprise-only feature requests (RBAC, faster refreshes) and feeds those signals to the account manager before renewal.



Examples of GTME organization structures

Our customers implement GTM engineering in different ways (and by different names), though the common goal is to build automated revenue engines. Here are some emerging models:

## Model 1: GTME inside RevOps (the dominant pattern)

At most mid-to-large companies, GTM Engineers report into RevOps or GTM ops. The function sometimes splits into prototypers and implementers, where generalists close to sales hack together proofs-of-concept, then engineers harden the winning ideas to touch millions of CRM rows without breaking.

- Intercom: [Alexander DeMoulin](#)'s GTM Ops team pilots new plays (e.g., TAM enrichment), while GTM Systems, embedded in R&D, scales methods to production.
- Canva: [Robert Jones](#)'s GTM AI team automates workflows such as transcript summarization, while a separate enrichment team pipes novel data into those plays. Longer-term, Canva may embed GTMEs directly inside sales, marketing, and CX tribes
- Notion: Three teams work together to drive RevOps and GTM AI. [Evan Peters](#) owns RevOps and Strategy with a GTM innovation pod to build workflows, experiment, and get hands-on commercially (reporting to the CRO). [Jalal Iftikhar](#) and [Shelley Lee](#)'s BizTech and automation engineering teams build foundational GTM systems and scale workflows (reporting to the CFO). [Theo Bleier](#) is an embedded AI engineer building and scaling applications (reporting through the CTO).
- Anthropic: Everything lives in one GTM Infrastructure & Incentives pod led by [Adam Wall](#). A "Productivity Engineering" sub-squad wields Claude + Clay to automate sales and marketing work.

Why it works: RevOps already owns data pipelines and quality, so lodging GTMEs here draws a straight line from "We spotted a friction point" to "We shipped the fix."

## Model 2: GTME within Growth

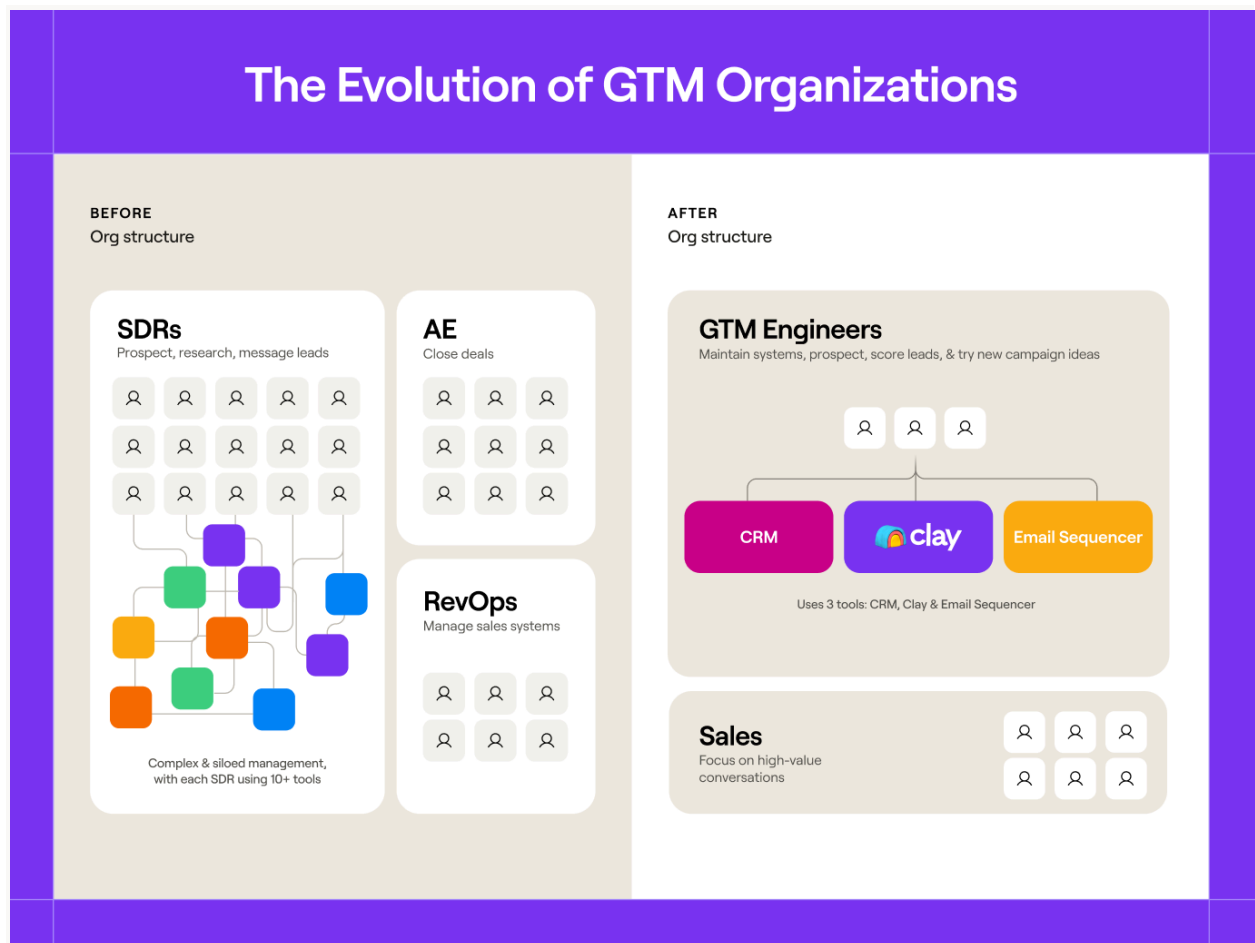
A second archetype puts GTM Engineers inside the Growth org.

- Ramp houses a Growth Platform squad, led by PMs like [Keyan Sarrafzadeh](#), who partner with Growth Engineering. They run two-week sprints, shipping internal prospecting tools, data aggregators, and AI outreach flows. A separate Business Systems group looks after core Salesforce plumbing.
- Verkada keeps its GTMEs in [Davide Grieco](#)'s Growth team under the CMO. Their charter is to generate demand and create systems that help the broader GTM organization. That ranges from generating personalized landing pages for ABM campaigns to automating 80% of SDR workflows so they can book 4x the number of meetings per month (80-100 per rep).
- Rippling runs GTM engineering within [Noah Adelstein](#)'s international growth team as well as the US growth team. These teams run frequent growth experiments, including automating outbound and direct mail campaigns.

Why it works: Embedding technical talent beside demand gen unlocks ideas (programmatic landing pages, real-time intent harvesting) that traditional marketers might never attempt.

## Cross-model lessons

1. Start in ops, federate later. Most companies incubate GTM Engineering under RevOps, then push talent outward once foundations are solid.
2. Balance rapid prototyping with stable implementation. Data engineering skills are often useful when you're ready to scale experiments that work.
3. Data hygiene is non-negotiable. Every win traces back to clean, enriched, well-modeled data.



How to hire a GTME

When teams first hear about GTM engineering, the next questions are always, *Who do I hire?* and *Where do I find them?*

Great GTM Engineers are often hybrids: half commercial thinker, half builder. (Think "marketers who are bad engineers" or engineers who care more about moving revenue than writing perfect code.)

Where to find them: These folks might be hanging out in Clay communities, RevOps groups, or posting on social media sites about automations. At Clay, some of our best hires came directly from our ICP.

What to look for:

- Technical fluency: They may not be classically trained, but they like learning new tools and vibe coding. Familiarity with Clay, n8n, Zapier, Lovable, Bolt, TypeScript, Python, or SQL is nice; the real signal is a willingness to learn by tinkering. (E.g., Our GTME Spencer started as a product designer and learned SQL on the job with Claude.)
- Commercial bias: They think about the ROI of their work, asking questions like *"Does this workflow actually help someone close a deal?"*
- Curiosity: They approach every go-to-market puzzle like detectives.
- Experimental mindset: They know how to test ideas, validate signals, and turn feedback loops into better systems.

How to assess them:

1. Business problem investigation

Hand them a fuzzy problem, e.g. "*Our trial-to-paid rate won't budge.*" Strong candidates start by asking:

- Who is our ICP?
- What are we missing in their journey?
- Which signals tell us someone is ready to buy or churn?

Good answers explore both *market* levers (new intent data) and *internal* levers (slow SDR-to-AE routing). Candidates should be specific, e.g. asking questions about your most successful customer calls to work backwards from there.

## 2. Systems sketch

Next, have them outline how they'd turn those insights into a working flow. Can they pick good/unique data points to track, keep them clean, and plug them into a Clay workflow? Watch for the mindset of someone who tests, measures results, and iterates.

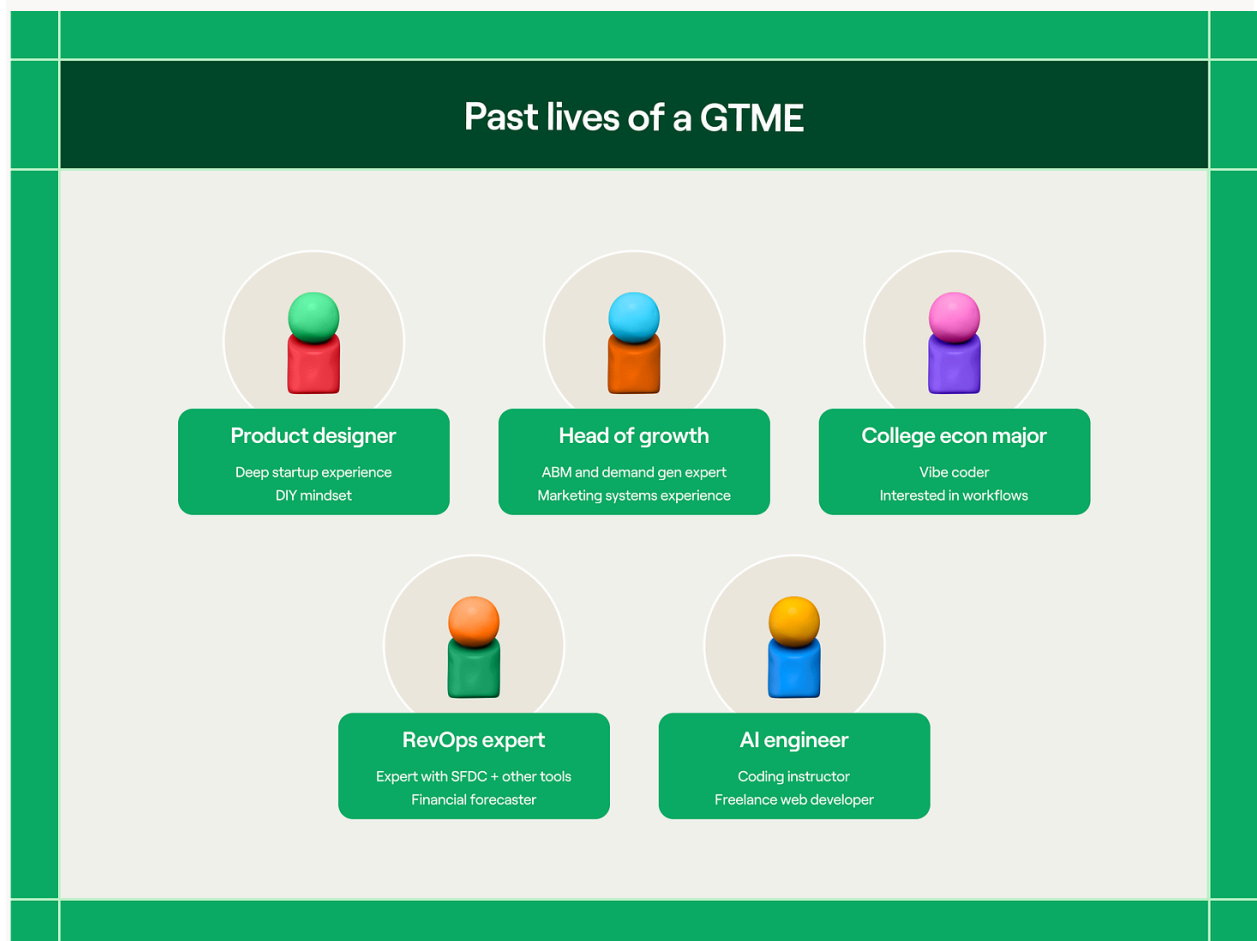
## 3. Mini build challenge

Give a take-home based on the above, e.g. design and validate a specific set of data points that predict churn. Any tool is fair game. A good submission:

- Explains assumptions and fallback logic
- Mentions suppression or multi-channel sequencing (no blast-all emails)
- Shows how they'll measure success and iterate

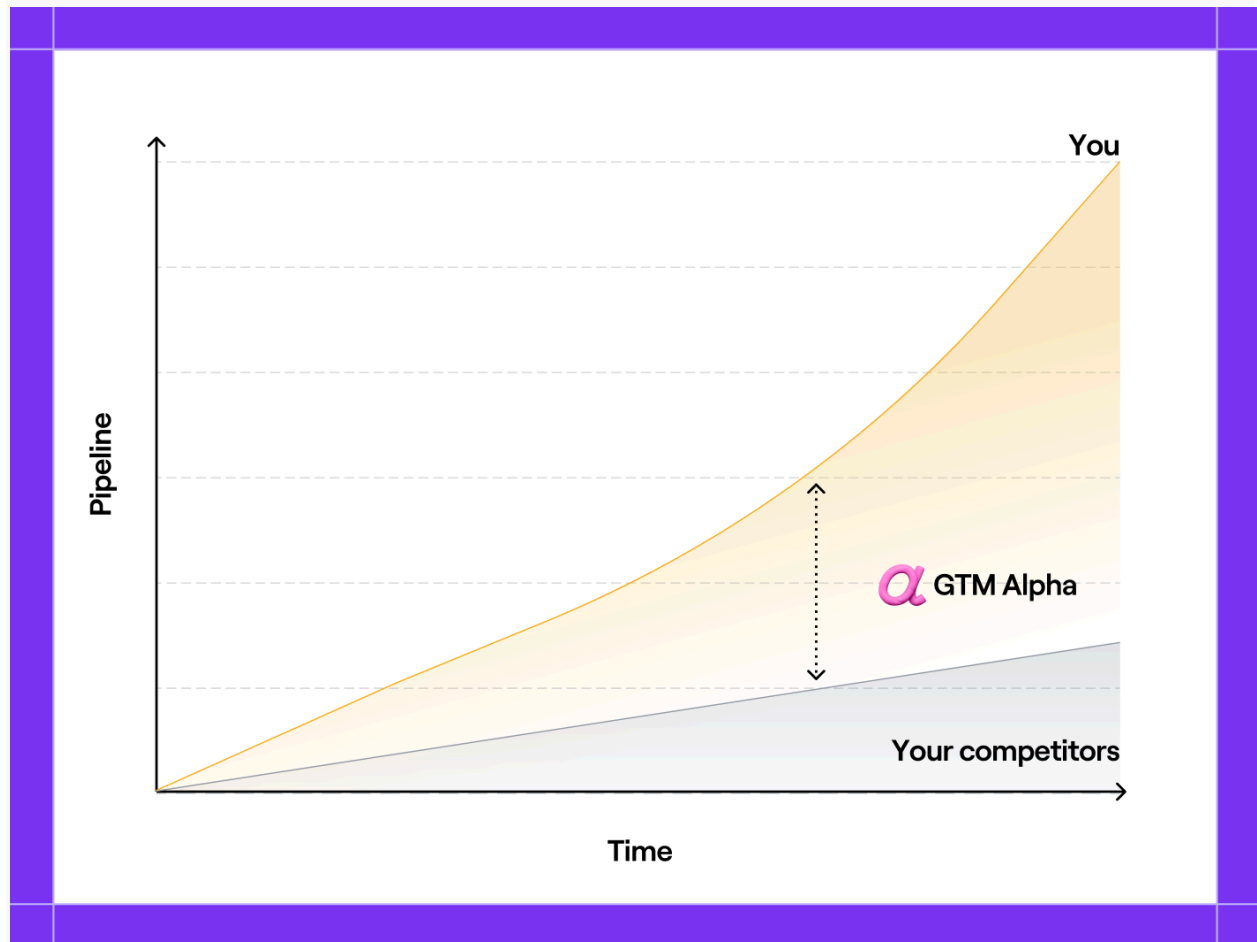
Red flags include tunnel vision, like if they only suggest one channel or ignore obvious risks like deliverability or targeting fatigue.

GTMEs can come from a variety of backgrounds. The diagram below is roughly representative of our team.



A systems-oriented future

GTM alpha belongs to teams that can build revenue engines with AI. As tools and tactics become commoditized, the edge shifts to how well you can design experiments and scale them fast. Hiring 10 more reps for every 10% pipeline lift won't cut it anymore.



Ops was never meant to live in the back office. Today, the teams closest to your data are also closest to new revenue. GTM Engineers turn ops from support function to growth engine: the connective tissue between product, sales, and marketing. While marketing drives awareness and brand, GTMEs build the infrastructure that turns it into repeatable revenue.

Your revenue problems aren't people problems. They're systems problems. And GTM engineers are the ones who fix them.

## Frequently Asked Questions

What is a GTM engineer, and why become one?

A GTM engineer builds automated revenue systems using AI, data enrichment, and workflow automation. The role sits at the intersection of commercial thinking and technical building. It emerged as a distinct function because AI collapsed the gap between idea and execution, making it possible for one person to design, test, and scale a GTM play without waiting for a developer or a data team.

What does a GTM engineer actually do day to day?

GTM engineers identify revenue bottlenecks, write specs, ship prototypes, and scale what works. In practice that means building workflows like intelligent inbound routing, CRM enrichment from call transcripts, churn-risk alerts, and personalized outbound campaigns. They measure success by outcomes: meetings booked, hours saved, trial conversion rates lifted.

What data signals are most important for GTM engineering?

The most valuable signals are the ones that predict purchase, expansion, or churn before they happen. That includes intent signals (reverse-IP visits, enterprise feature requests in support threads), firmographic triggers (new DoorDash listings, hiring

patterns), and behavioral signals (trial activation milestones, support ticket spikes). GTM engineers build propensity scores and ICP models on top of these signals to prioritize who to reach and when.

## Where should a GTM engineer sit in the org?

Most companies start by embedding GTM engineers inside RevOps, because RevOps already owns data pipelines and quality. From there, many federate outward into growth or customer success once the data foundation is solid. Companies like Intercom, Notion, and Anthropic all use variations of this pattern.

## Do GTM engineers need to know how to code?

Not necessarily. The real signal is a willingness to learn by tinkering. Familiarity with tools like Clay, n8n, Zapier, or SQL is useful, but GTM engineers at Clay have come from backgrounds as varied as product design, RevOps, and sales. One GTME (Spencer) started as a product designer and learned SQL on the job using Claude.

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*Thanks to Evan Peters, Alexander Demoulin, Robert Jones, Adam Wall, Davide Grieco, Keyan Sarrafzadeh, Noah Adelstein, Keith Jones, Rachel Hepworth, and most of all, every GTME at Clay for helping shape the ideas in this article. To follow along with GTM engineering at Clay, subscribe to our [Substack](#).*